SSC MTS 2023 question paper with answers

8 September 2023 · Shift 1

49 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: 3 marks a question; no negative marking in Session-I (Numerical and Mathematical Ability, Reasoning), 1 mark deducted for each wrong answer in Session-II (General Awareness, English).

The other 41 of the paper's 90 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20231223070914/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/Writeup_MTS2023_22122023.pdf

Numerical and Mathematical Ability 1 question

Q.18

The cost price of an item is ₹4,850. What is the profit percentage (rounded off to 1 decimal place) if it is sold at ₹6,680?

(A) 44.6%
(B) 37.7%
(C) 39.5%
(D) 35.5%

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving 1 question

Q.12

Seven people, U, M, K, G, B, R and D are sitting in a straight line, facing south. Only two people sit to the left of B. M sits third to the right of G. U is the immediate neighbour of M and B. D sits to the immediate left of K. Total how many people sit between D and G?

(A) Two
(B) Three
(C) One
(D) Four

General Awareness 22 questions

Q.1

Which Indian Mass Movement began with the famous ‘Dandi March’ of Mahatma Gandhi?

(A) Civil Disobedience Movement
(B) Non-Cooperation Movement
(C) Quit India Movement
(D) Kheda Movement

Q.3

The length of the men's kabaddi court is _____ metres.

(A) 10
(B) 13
(C) 17
(D) 15

Q.6

Which of the following is NOT a Directive Principle based on the ideals of Mahatma Gandhi?

(A) To promote industrialisation in urban areas
(B) To organise village Panchayats
(C) To prohibit intoxicating drinks and drugs that are injurious to health
(D) To promote cottage industries in rural areas

Q.7

Which of the following methods is used to calculate national income by summing up the total incomes earned by individuals and businesses in an economy?

(A) Value-added method
(B) Output method
(C) Income method
(D) Expenditure method

Q.8

What is personal income?

(A) The income earned by individuals and households after taxes and other deductions
(B) The total income earned by businesses and corporations in an economy
(C) The income earned by individuals through their own business or self-employment
(D) The total income earned by individuals and households before taxes and other deductions

Q.9

Who founded the Hindu reform organisation Brahmo Samaj?

(A) Ramkrishna Paramhans
(B) Rabindranath Tagore
(C) Atmaram Pandurang
(D) Raja Ram Mohan Roy

Q.10

Whom among the following Indian singers is known as ‘Gazal King’?

(A) Manna Dey
(B) Mukesh
(C) Shailendra
(D) Jagjit Singh

Q.11

Dree Utsav is celebrated in the state of _____.

(A) Arunachal Pradesh
(B) Kerala
(C) Assam
(D) Andhra Pradesh

Q.12

_____ word of Indian dance is derived from a Sanskrit word and literally means ‘taking towards’.

(A) Nritta
(B) Laasya
(C) Taandava
(D) Abhinaya

Q.13

Which of the following is an example of the Western Coast Port?

(A) Tuticorin Port
(B) Paradip Port
(C) Mumbai Port
(D) Vishakhapatnam Port

Q.14

What are the three tiers of the Government in India?

(A) Union government, Judiciary government and Federal government
(B) Union government, State Government and Federal Government
(C) Union government, State government and Judiciary government
(D) Union Government, State Government and Local Government

Q.15

The foundation of Sanchi Stupa was laid by which of the following Kings?

(A) Samudragupta
(B) Bimbisara
(C) Ashoka
(D) Chandragupta Maurya

Q.16
During which months do retreating monsoons occur in India?

(A) January and February
(B) May and June
(C) October and November
(D) March and April

Q.17
Which is the primary structural component responsible for most of the mechanical strength of the cell wall?

(A) Heparin
(B) Glycogen
(C) Chitin
(D) Cellulose

Q.18
Ball and spring model of chemical bonds obey:

(A) Hooke's law
(B) Charles' law
(C) gravitational law
(D) Newton's law

Q.19
Pandit Janki Prasad was associated with which of the following Gharanas of Kathak?

(A) Banaras
(B) Raigarh
(C) Jaipur
(D) Lucknow

Q.20
In 2023, Ajay Singh, the chief of SpiceJet was appointed as president of which of the following?

(A) FICCI
(B) ASSOCHAM
(C) CII
(D) NASSCOM

Q.21
Rohit Sharma became the first ever Indian to play how many T20 cricket matches in October 2022?

(A) 300
(B) 100
(C) 200
(D) 400

Q.22
Which form of Indian dance is said to be ‘soft and suitable for female presentation’?

(A) Nritta
(B) Taandava
(C) Laasya
(D) Nritya

Q.23
Which of the following oceans is surrounded by the continent of North America and South America to the east?

(A) Pacific Ocean
(B) Atlantic Ocean
(C) Indian Ocean
(D) Arctic Ocean

Q.24
The famous ‘Pashupatinath Temple’ is located in which country from the following?

(A) Nepal
(B) Bhutan
(C) Maldives
(D) Sri Lanka

Q.25
In which of the following years was the first Janjatiya Khel Mahotsav held?

(A) 2023
(B) 2021
(C) 2020
(D) 2022

English Language and Comprehension 25 questions

Q.1

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. One who does not believe in the existence of God

(A) Atheist
(B) Priest
(C) Monk
(D) Believer

Q.2

Select the most appropriate option that can rectify the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to rectify it, select 'no rectification needed'. You are the "beautiful" woman I have ever seen.

(A) no rectification needed
(B) more beautiful
(C) beauty
(D) most beautiful

Q.3

Choose the option which best expresses the meaning of the given idiom. By fair means or foul

(A) To work without planning
(B) To find difficulty in completing some work
(C) To get one's way with honesty or dishonesty
(D) To provoke someone into quarrelling

Q.4

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. My younger daughter, / Kanu prefer / dark chocolate / to yoghurt.

(A) dark chocolate
(B) My younger daughter
(C) Kanu prefer
(D) to yoghurt

Q.5

Choose the sentence that contains an error.

(A) I saw a movie that was directed by Steven Spielberg.
(B) She is the only person who can solve this difficult math problem.
(C) He is an lawyer who works for a prestigious law firm.
(D) The Great Wall of China is a popular tourist attraction.

Q.6

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. Select the option that contains an error. Ishita will playing Tennis for her favourite team.

(A) will playing
(B) Tennis for
(C) her favourite team
(D) Ishita

Q.7

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. He "apologised in her" silently before he pushed deeper into her thoughts.

(A) apologise in her
(B) apologised with her
(C) apologised of her
(D) apologised to her

Q.8

Select the correctly spelt word.

(A) Bihavior
(B) Behavier
(C) Behaviour
(D) Behaveor

Q.9

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Obvious

(A) Clear
(B) Murky
(C) Ambiguous
(D) Opaque

Q.10

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. As phony as a three-dollar bill

(A) Something that is attractive
(B) Something that is genuine
(C) Something that is disgusting
(D) Something that is fake

Q.11

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. They are going to give me a lovely present, but I cannot ____ what it will be.

(A) give
(B) gist
(C) guess
(D) guest

Q.12

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Important
(B) Maintanance
(C) Friend
(D) Rhythm

Q.13

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Determined

(A) Flexible
(B) Famous
(C) Decisive
(D) Elevated

Q.14

Select the most appropriate synonym of the underlined word. Ray was “cynical” about love.

(A) prolific
(B) obese
(C) trusting
(D) pessimistic

Q.15

Select the option that rectifies the spelling of the underlined word in the given sentence. The company sent out a “questionaire” to its employees to gather feedback on their work environment.

(A) questioneire
(B) questionnaire
(C) questionnire
(D) questionaiare

Q.16

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. A person who feeds on human flesh

(A) Cannibal
(B) Carnivore
(C) Nudge
(D) Omnivore

Q.17

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select ‘No substitution required’. Larger emissions of greenhouse gases “lead to higher concentrations” in the atmosphere.

(A) leaded to higher concentrations
(B) have lead to higher concentrations
(C) is lead to higher concentrations
(D) No substitution required

Q.18

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom. Ramesh always “blows his own trumpet”.

(A) praises himself
(B) criticises himself
(C) does his own work
(D) depends on others

Q.19

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom. He was “on cloud nine” when he got admission in Cambridge University.

(A) involved in useless journey
(B) very happy
(C) unsettled
(D) available to be called to go to work

Q.20

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. An examination of a body after death

(A) Post room
(B) Post death
(C) Post partum
(D) Post mortem

Q.21

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each number. One of the (1)_____ tragedies is seeing someone with incredible talent get (2)_____ because he or she lacks some basic skills. This book (3)_____ the number one reason executives derail, and it provides extremely helpful tools to operate in a fast-paced, result-oriented environment. I am impressed by how insightful, (4)_____, well organised and focused it is. It will surely help one (5)_____ several difficult situations.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) more great
(B) great
(C) greater
(D) greatest

Q.22

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each number. One of the (1)_____ tragedies is seeing someone with incredible talent get (2)_____ because he or she lacks some basic skills. This book (3)_____ the number one reason executives derail, and it provides extremely helpful tools to operate in a fast-paced, result-oriented environment. I am impressed by how insightful, (4)_____, well organised and focused it is. It will surely help one (5)_____ several difficult situations.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) uplifted
(B) damaged
(C) derailed
(D) channelised

Q.23

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each number. One of the (1)_____ tragedies is seeing someone with incredible talent get (2)_____ because he or she lacks some basic skills. This book (3)_____ the number one reason executives derail, and it provides extremely helpful tools to operate in a fast-paced, result-oriented environment. I am impressed by how insightful, (4)_____, well organised and focused it is. It will surely help one (5)_____ several difficult situations.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) demeans
(B) devours
(C) addresses
(D) neglects

Q.24

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each number. One of the (1)_____ tragedies is seeing someone with incredible talent get (2)_____ because he or she lacks some basic skills. This book (3)_____ the number one reason executives derail, and it provides extremely helpful tools to operate in a fast-paced, result-oriented environment. I am impressed by how insightful, (4)_____, well organised and focused it is. It will surely help one (5)_____ several difficult situations.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) sophisticated

(B) pessimistic

(C) cumbersome

(D) readable

Q.25

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each number. One of the (1)_____ tragedies is seeing someone with incredible talent get (2)_____ because he or she lacks some basic skills. This book (3)_____ the number one reason executives derail, and it provides extremely helpful tools to operate in a fast-paced, result-oriented environment. I am impressed by how insightful, (4)_____, well organised and focused it is. It will surely help one (5)_____ several difficult situations.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) condemn

(B) salvage

(C) reject

(D) discourage

Answer key

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.18 **(B)**

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving

Q.12 **(B)**

General Awareness

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.6 **(A)**	Q.7 **(C)**	Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(D)**
Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(D)**	Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(C)**
Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(A)**	Q.19 **(A)**	Q.20 **(B)**	Q.21 **(D)**
Q.22 **(C)**	Q.23 **(A)**	Q.24 **(A)**	Q.25 **(A)**		

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(A)**
Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(C)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(B)**
Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(A)**
Q.19 **(B)**	Q.20 **(D)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(C)**	Q.23 **(C)**	Q.24 **(D)**
Q.25 **(B)**					

Explanations

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.18 · Answer (B) 37.7%

Profit = 6,680 − 4,850 = ₹1,830, and 1,830/4,850 × 100 = 37.73%, about 37.7%.

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving

Q.12 · Answer (B) Three

Counting from the people's own left end: only two sit to B's left, so B is third. U sits between M and B, so U is fourth and M fifth (M cannot be first, with G three places to its left), and G is second. D and K take sixth and seventh, and R the first seat: R, G, B, U, M, D, K. B, U and M sit between G and D: three.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (A) Civil Disobedience Movement

Gandhi's march from Sabarmati to Dandi in March-April 1930, which ended in his breaking the salt law, launched the Civil Disobedience Movement.

Q.3 · Answer (B) 13

A men's kabaddi court measures 13 m by 10 m; the women's court is 12 m by 8 m.

Q.6 · Answer (A) To promote industrialisation in urban areas

The Gandhian Directive Principles include organising village panchayats (Article 40), promoting cottage industries in rural areas (Article 43) and prohibiting intoxicating drinks and drugs injurious to health (Article 47). Promoting industrialisation in urban areas is not among them.

Q.7 · Answer (C) Income method

The income method adds up the factor incomes earned in the economy: wages, rent, interest and profits, with the mixed income of the self-employed.

Q.8 · Answer (D) The total income earned by individuals and households before taxes and other deductions

Personal income is the income households actually receive from all sources, transfer payments included, before personal taxes are paid; what is left after those taxes is personal disposable income.

Q.9 · Answer (D) Raja Ram Mohan Roy

Raja Ram Mohan Roy founded the Brahmo Sabha in Calcutta in 1828; it came to be known as the Brahmo Samaj.

Q.10 · Answer (D) Jagjit Singh

Jagjit Singh, who took the ghazal to a wide popular audience, is known as the 'Ghazal King'.

Q.11 · Answer (A) Arunachal Pradesh

Dree is the agricultural festival of the Apatani people of the Ziro valley in Arunachal Pradesh, held every July with prayers for a good harvest.

Q.12 · Answer (D) Abhinaya

'Abhinaya' comes from the Sanskrit 'abhi' (towards) and 'ni' (to carry or lead): expression that carries the meaning of the dance to the audience.

Q.13 · Answer (C) Mumbai Port

Mumbai Port is on India's west coast, in Maharashtra; Tuticorin, Paradip and Visakhapatnam are ports on the east coast.

Q.14 · Answer (D) Union Government, State Government and Local Government

India is governed at three levels: the Union government, the state governments and local government (panchayats and municipalities, given constitutional status by the 73rd and 74th Amendments of 1992).

Q.15 · Answer (C) Ashoka
The Great Stupa at Sanchi was first built by Ashoka in the 3rd century BCE as a brick mound over relics of the Buddha; it was later enlarged and faced with stone.

Q.16 · Answer (C) October and November
The south-west monsoon withdraws from northern India during October and November, the season of the retreating monsoon.

Q.17 · Answer (D) Cellulose
Cellulose fibres give the plant cell wall most of its strength. Chitin strengthens the cell walls of fungi, glycogen is an animal storage carbohydrate and heparin an anticoagulant.

Q.18 · Answer (A) Hooke's law
In the ball-and-spring model the atoms are balls joined by springs, and a stretched or compressed bond pulls back with a force proportional to its change in length, as Hooke's law states.

Q.19 · Answer (A) Banaras
Pandit Janki Prasad is regarded as the founder of the Banaras gharana of Kathak.

Q.20 · Answer (B) ASSOCHAM
Ajay Singh, chairman and managing director of SpiceJet, took over as president of ASSOCHAM (the Associated Chambers of Commerce and Industry of India) in March 2023, succeeding Sumant Sinha.

Q.21 · Answer (D) 400
In the second T20I against South Africa at Guwahati on 2 October 2022, Rohit Sharma became the first Indian to play 400 T20 matches, counting internationals, the IPL and domestic games together.

Q.22 · Answer (C) Laasya
Laasya is the soft, graceful side of dance, associated with Parvati and suited to female presentation; Taandava, Shiva's dance, is its vigorous counterpart.

Q.23 · Answer (A) Pacific Ocean
The Pacific Ocean has Asia and Australia to its west and North and South America to its east.

Q.24 · Answer (A) Nepal
The Pashupatinath Temple, dedicated to Shiva, stands on the banks of the Bagmati in Kathmandu, Nepal.

Q.25 · Answer (A) 2023
The first Janjatiya Khel Mahotsav, a national sports festival for tribal athletes, was held at KIIT, Bhubaneswar, in June 2023.

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 · Answer (A) Atheist
An 'atheist' does not believe that God exists; a believer does, and a priest and a monk are religious figures.

Q.2 · Answer (D) most beautiful
A comparison with everyone 'I have ever seen' needs the superlative: 'You are the most beautiful woman I have ever seen.'

Q.3 · Answer (C) To get one’s way with honesty or dishonesty
'By fair means or foul' means by any method at all, honest or dishonest.

Q.4 · Answer (C) Kanu prefer
The subject 'Kanu' (my younger daughter) is singular and takes a singular verb: 'Kanu prefers dark chocolate to yoghurt.'

Q.5 · Answer (C) He is an lawyer who works for a prestigious law firm.
'Lawyer' begins with a consonant sound, so it takes 'a': 'He is a lawyer who works for a prestigious law firm.'

Q.6 · Answer (A) will playing
SSC's key gives 'will playing': the modal 'will' is followed by the bare infinitive, 'Ishita will play (or will be playing) tennis for her favourite team.' The capital in 'Tennis' is also non-standard, but that is a slip of capitalisation, not of grammar.

Q.7 · Answer (D) apologised to her
One apologises 'to' a person (and 'for' a fault): 'He apologised to her silently'.

Q.8 · Answer (C) Behaviour
The correct (British) spelling is 'behaviour'.

Q.9 · Answer (A) Clear
'Obvious' means easy to see or understand: 'clear'. 'Murky', 'ambiguous' and 'opaque' are nearly its opposites.

Q.10 · Answer (D) Something that is fake
There is no three-dollar bill in US currency, so something 'as phony as a three-dollar bill' is plainly fake.

Q.11 · Answer (C) guess
The present is a surprise, so the speaker cannot 'guess' what it will be; 'guest' and 'gist' only look similar.

Q.12 · Answer (B) Maintanance
The correct spelling is 'maintenance'.

Q.13 · Answer (C) Decisive
'Determined' means firm and resolute in a decision: 'decisive'. 'Flexible' is nearly its opposite.

Q.14 · Answer (D) pessimistic
To be 'cynical' about love is to doubt that it is sincere or will last: 'pessimistic'. 'Trusting' is its opposite.

Q.15 · Answer (B) questionnaire
The correct spelling is 'questionnaire', with a double 'n'.

Q.16 · Answer (A) Cannibal
A 'cannibal' eats human flesh; a carnivore eats meat in general and an omnivore both plants and animals.

Q.17 · Answer (D) No substitution required
The plural subject 'emissions' takes the plural present 'lead', which suits a general truth. 'Leaded' is not the past of 'lead', and 'have lead' and 'is lead' are wrong forms.

Q.18 · Answer (A) praises himself
To 'blow one's own trumpet' is to boast about oneself, to praise oneself.

Q.19 · Answer (B) very happy
To be 'on cloud nine' is to be extremely happy.

Q.20 · Answer (D) Post mortem
A 'post mortem' (an autopsy) is the examination of a body after death; 'post partum' means after childbirth.

Q.21 · Answer (D) greatest
'One of the' is followed by a superlative and a plural noun: 'one of the greatest tragedies'.

Q.22 · Answer (C) derailed
A talented person gets 'derailed', thrown off course, for want of basic skills; the next sentence picks up the same image ('the number one reason executives derail').

Q.23 · Answer (C) addresses
The book 'addresses', that is, deals with, the main reason executives derail, and then provides tools to help.

Q.24 · Answer (D) readable
The writer is praising the book ('insightful', 'well organised', 'focused'), so the blank needs another favourable word: 'readable'.

Q.25 · Answer (B) salvage

To 'salvage' a situation is to rescue it from going wrong, which is the help the book gives.

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